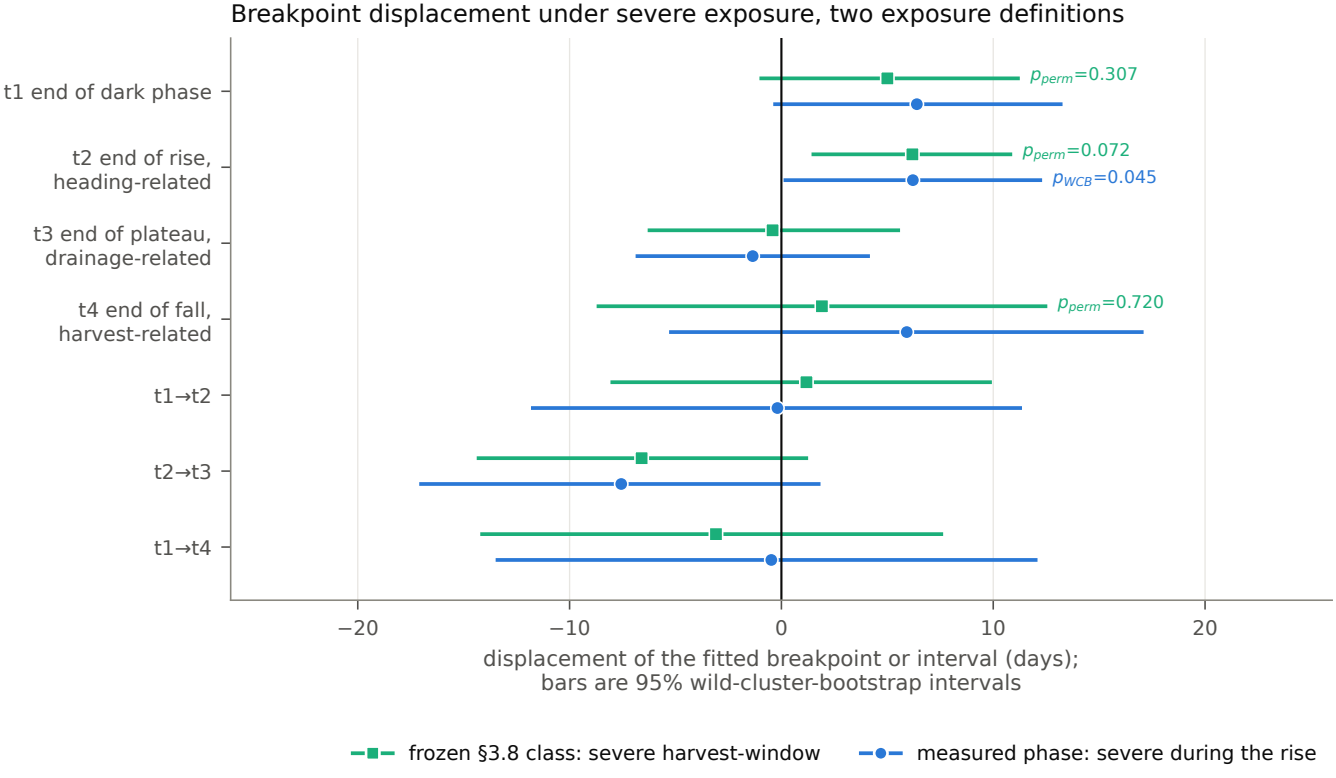

Not causal effects. §3.9's timing placebo — which requires severe harvest-window exposure to leave the SAME season's t1 breakpoint unmoved — is rejected in the robustness arm (+7.44 d, p_{perm}=0.040). A separate synthetic perturbation shows that this fitted five-segment breakpoint can move after a late-season backscatter change; that is a plausible estimator pathway, not the identified cause here. p_{perm} where §3.9's permutation test covers the indicator, p_{WCB} otherwise — the reference schemes differ. Within-state exchangeability is unverified; this comparison neither calibrates the bootstrap nor identifies why the association arose (§4.1.7).